SUPPLIER PROPOSAL | RESPONSE TO RFP-2026-041

Enterprise Procurement & Supplier Management Platform

Submitted to Northstar Manufacturing Group

CedarStack Technologies Private Limited

Technical, Implementation, Commercial and Service Response

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Executive Summary

CedarStack proposes a security-focused supplier collaboration platform with strong document governance, access controls and a hands-on managed support model. The bid is competitively priced and can launch in 14 weeks. Its main limitations are functional depth and integration maturity: some advanced sourcing and supplier performance workflows require manual steps, and its SAP connector is not yet production-certified. CedarStack positions these as controlled phase-two enhancements rather than launch blockers.

Important note: This document is fictional, created solely for testing a classroom RFP evaluation application. Supplier names, contacts, certifications, customer references, performance claims and commercial amounts are synthetic and must not be treated as real-world claims.

1. Technical Capability and Solution Fit

1.1 Proposed architecture

CedarStack Gatehouse is a modular web platform deployed in a dedicated virtual private cloud in India. The application uses a relational database, managed object storage and a separate identity service. Infrastructure is defined using version-controlled templates and deployed through a documented release pipeline. The bidder reports a 500-user acceptance test but has not provided a detailed concurrency profile. Data export and document retention controls are more developed than the platform analytics layer.

1.2 Integration approach

Entra ID SAML SSO and MFA policies are included. Supplier master data can be imported by validated CSV and exported on demand. A REST API is available for selected supplier and document endpoints; the SAP S/4HANA connector is currently in pilot and is not included as a certified standard integration. Microsoft 365 support covers Outlook notifications and SharePoint links. The proposal includes a 10-day integration discovery sprint but does not commit to automated purchase-order synchronisation in phase one.

1.3 Functional scope

Supplier self-registration, configurable document checklists, certificate expiry notifications, RFQ invitation and file upload, bid tabulation, three-stage approvals, contract version control, evidence retention and compliance dashboards. The standard product has limited supplier scorecard automation and no built-in corrective-action workflow. Advanced spend analytics are delivered through downloadable reports. Field-level audit history is retained for supplier master, document and approval records.

1.4 Buyer environment and common scope

The response is made against the same Northstar requirements supplied to all bidders:

- **Buyer and programme:** Northstar Manufacturing Group (fictional) operates four manufacturing plants and three regional offices in India. The programme covers approximately 1,200 employees, 500 potential platform users and 180 active suppliers.
- **Required workflows:** Supplier registration and onboarding; document collection and due diligence; RFQ creation and supplier responses; configurable evaluation scorecards; multi-level approvals; contract and certificate repository; supplier performance reviews; and spend / sourcing dashboards.
- **Enterprise environment:** The buyer currently uses SAP S/4HANA for finance and purchasing, Microsoft Entra ID for identity, and Microsoft 365 for collaboration. REST APIs, SSO and role-based access are expected. CSV exchange may be used only as a documented interim workaround.
- **Security and resilience expectations:** The buyer expects MFA, encryption in transit and at rest, audit trails, vulnerability management, independent security testing, India data-residency clarity, a documented incident process, 99.9% monthly availability, target RTO of four hours and target RPO of one hour.

2. Implementation Plan and Commercial Proposal

2.1 Delivery plan and milestones

CedarStack proposes a 14-week implementation. Weeks 1-2: discovery, security design and workflow prioritisation. Weeks 3-4: dedicated environment, identity and access policies. Weeks 5-7: supplier onboarding, document controls and contract repository. Weeks 8-9: RFQ and approval configuration. Weeks 10-11: CSV/API integration and migration. Weeks 12-13: UAT, security validation and training. Week 14: controlled go-live. The plan assumes phase-one acceptance of CSV-based SAP data exchange and manual purchase-order reference updates.

Milestone	Evidence / exit condition
Design approval	Signed solution design, scope and responsibility matrix
Configuration complete	Configured workflows, roles and supplier forms available in test
Integration and migration	Interface test evidence and reconciled migration totals
User acceptance	Buyer-approved test results and defect disposition
Go-live	Cutover checklist, training completion and support handover

2.2 Commercial schedule (INR, excluding GST)

Cost component	Amount
One-time implementation and configuration	INR 14,00,000
Identity and data migration package	INR 4,00,000
Annual subscription (500 users)	INR 21,00,000
Annual managed support	INR 3,00,000
Year 1 total before taxes	INR 42,00,000
Three-year total before taxes	INR 90,00,000

The three-year total includes 1 TB document storage, standard upgrades, two non-production environments and 30 hours of configuration assistance annually. SAP connector certification and purchase-order automation are excluded and will be estimated after the pilot. Extra storage is INR 1,00,000 per TB per year. GST is extra. Payment terms are 25% on signature, 25% on environment readiness, 25% at UAT and 25% at go-live.

2.3 Commercial assumptions and exclusions

The commercial proposal is based on 500 users, 1 TB storage and phase-one CSV integration. Automated SAP purchase-order synchronisation, advanced scorecard automation and corrective-action workflows are excluded. Buyer supplies clean supplier and contract metadata. GST is extra.

3. Security, Compliance, Support and Delivery Risks

3.1 Information security and compliance

CedarStack states that its company-wide ISMS is certified to ISO/IEC 27001:2022 (certificate CS-ISMS-2025-071; stated expiry 18 September 2028). A 2026 independent penetration-test letter is included in the bid appendix and states that no critical or high findings remained open at retest. Data is hosted in Mumbai in a dedicated VPC. TLS 1.2+ and AES-256 storage encryption are enabled. MFA is mandatory for administrators and buyer users; supplier MFA can be policy-enforced. Privileged access is time-bound and logged. The bidder has not supplied a SOC 2 Type II report. Its incident response schedule provides notification within 48 hours after confirmation.

3.2 Availability, backup and disaster recovery

CedarStack commits to 99.9% monthly uptime. Stated RTO is four hours and RPO is four hours. Backups run every four hours and are retained for 30 days; monthly restore testing is documented. A disaster recovery exercise was completed in June 2026. The RPO commitment is less stringent than the one-hour planning target.

3.3 Support model and service levels

Managed support includes 24x7 P1 intake, 8x5 IST P2-P4 coverage, a named service lead and monthly operational reviews. P1 acknowledgement is 45 minutes with target workaround in six hours. P2 acknowledgement is four business hours. The bidder provides a dedicated onboarding specialist for the first month and quarterly refresher sessions. Support staffing is a 12-person India team, with three engineers cross-trained on the platform.

3.4 Key risks and dependencies

SAP purchase-order automation is not production-certified and phase one relies on CSV/manual steps. Automated scorecards, corrective actions and advanced spend analytics are less mature than the broader procurement suites. The RPO is four hours rather than the one-hour target. The security certification and penetration evidence are comparatively strong, but no SOC 2 report was supplied.

3.5 Relevant customer experience and references

Reference A: Lotus Medical Devices (fictional), 380 users, controlled supplier document portal, live since 2024. Reference B: Aranya Packaging (fictional), 520 users, onboarding and contract repository, live since 2023. Reference calls can be arranged; both deployments are document-governance focused rather than full-scale sourcing transformation.

4. Closing Statement

CedarStack appreciates the opportunity to respond to RFP-2026-041. The statements in this proposal are submitted for evaluation against the buyer's requirements and are subject to contract, final design validation and mutually agreed acceptance criteria.

Authorized representative: Meera Iyer, Director - Product and Delivery

End of proposal. All case data in this PDF is synthetic and intended for software testing only.